

Sofia Marin

Integrative therapy for adults · Brighton and online

PREPARED BY

Alexander Watson Studio

STAGE

Before website design

STATUS

For your review

DATE

September 2026

The direction of the website is decided here.

A Practice Clarity Blueprint sets the strategic and creative direction for your practice before any design work begins: how the practice is described, who the website should speak to most directly, how it should sound, and how it should look. Once it is agreed, the design stage builds on these decisions instead of reopening them.

Read it as a description of your practice that you are entitled to correct. Where something is factually wrong, correct it. Where something is right but put badly, say that too — it is an equally useful correction.

HOW TO READ IT

- **Established.** Facts you have given us. Nothing factual has been assumed; anything not yet established is listed below instead of being filled in.
- **Interpretation.** Our reading of what you told us. Much of this document is interpretation, and correcting it is the main purpose of your review.
- **Recommendation.** Proposals for the identity and the website. Yours to approve, adjust or refuse.

Each page is marked at the top right: the first six sections set out our understanding of the practice, the next six turn it into creative recommendations.

UNDERSTANDING THE PRACTICE

- 01 Practice at a glance
- 02 Professional identity
- 03 Philosophy of practice
- 04 The people you want to reach
- 05 Messaging and voice
- 06 Intended client experience

CREATIVE RECOMMENDATION

- 07 Brand direction
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- 09 Colour
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- 11 Photography and imagery
- 12 Website translation

SUMMARY AND APPROVAL

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TO CONFIRM BEFORE PUBLICATION

Qualification and awarding body · Professional register and membership number · Insurance · Supervision arrangement · Years in practice · Anything you want stated about your training

These are deliberately blank. Nothing of this kind will appear on the website until you supply it.

A practice organised around one question.

THE PRACTITIONER

An integrative therapist working in central Brighton and online, Tuesday to Friday. Nine years in theatre production before training.

THE PEOPLE

Adults whose lives are working. They arrive saying there is nothing actually wrong, and the website should take that at face value before it complicates it.

THE CENTRAL CONCERN

Fit rather than crisis. What happens when a life built out of sensible decisions stops belonging to the person living it.

THE FEELING TO CREATE

Being taken seriously without being categorised. Recognition without a label attached to it.

Nothing is wrong in a way a form would recognise.

SOFIA MARIN, AT DISCOVERY

THE PRACTICAL FACTS

Fee	£70
Session length	50 minutes
Days	Tuesday to Friday
Delivery	Brighton and online, equally
First conversation	Free, twenty minutes

Precise before reassuring.

Corrective

You begin by correcting an assumption before making a promise — “integrative isn’t a hedge.” The instinct is to be understood accurately first and liked second.

Practically frank

The stairs, the absent lift, the late-cancellation charge and the reply that may not come until the next working day belong in your own voice, in the body of the site, not in small print.

Transparent about method

You move between approaches and say when you are doing it — *“I’d rather be caught changing approach than be consistent and useless.”* The website should put method where most practices put credentials.

Attentive to language

You are interested in the small translation people do before they speak, including in their own language. Words are the material you work in, and the writing should show that instead of saying it.

Unwilling to overclaim

You are wary of promising that therapy makes people happier. Saying plainly what you can and cannot claim reads as competence, not modesty, and the website should give it a section of its own.

A second career, quietly used

Nine years in production informs how you think; it is not what you sell. It should appear once, be explained in a sentence, and then be left alone.

A therapist who would rather be exact than comforting, on the grounds that accuracy is the more useful kindness.

IDENTITY STATEMENT

The account is stable. The meaning is not.

Our reading of the position you described. It decides what the website is organised around, so it is worth disagreeing with if we have it wrong.

A life is rarely mistaken about its facts. It is carrying an account of them that has been repeated until it went smooth. Adulthood, on this view, is something constructed — assembled out of decisions that were sensible at the time and are now being lived inside by a different person.

Distress arrives as loss of fit rather than as breakdown. That is harder to justify to other people, and therefore lonelier.

This is what the practice actually works on, which is why it should organise the website instead of sitting inside it as a paragraph.

WHAT FOLLOWS FROM IT

- Change begins with re-reading. The event stays; what it meant is what moves.
- Accuracy comes before improvement. What therapy reliably does is make things more accurate, which is a smaller claim than making them better.
- Identity is treated as a question of fit more than discovery: the work is noticing that the description and the person have come apart.
- A client is not required to arrive with insight. “You don't have to arrive with it. That's what the sessions are for.”

What happens when the life you constructed stops fitting.

DEFINING BELIEF, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Functioning, and privately out of alignment.

This sets who the website should speak to most directly. It is a question of emphasis in the writing — not a limit on who you will see, and not a clinical boundary.

VISIBLE FROM OUTSIDE

A career chosen carefully. A relationship that is kind. Friendships, a city, a family that is proud of them. They are frequently the capable one, the person everyone finds easy.

HAPPENING INSIDE

Flatness after arriving at the thing they worked towards. Effort spent holding a life steady that no longer registers as effort. A suspicion the life belongs to a previous occupant.

WHAT HAS STOPPED FITTING

A career, a friendship pattern, a family expectation, somewhere that was meant to be temporary years ago, or a version of themselves other people are relying on.

WHAT THEY HOPE FOR

To say something accurately for once. To stop performing the description. Permission not to know what it is before asking for help with it.

TWO THINGS THEY ARE WARY OF

Being categorised. They have often been read a certain way for years, accurately or not, and are tired of it. A page that names their type does the same thing again.

Being handled. They can see technique working on them. Warm second-person copy — “you’re exhausted, you’re carrying so much” — reads to this reader as a method rather than a welcome.

One message, and the voice that carries it.

Therapy for adults, for the point at which a life stops fitting.

PRIMARY MESSAGE

YOU DON'T HAVE TO NAME IT

The requirement to diagnose yourself before asking for help should be removed explicitly, once, next to the action: *you don't need to be able to say what it is.*

THE METHOD IS VISIBLE

What you do, what you will not do, and what you ask of a client, all stated plainly. Trust is offered through description rather than assertion.

THE FACTS ARE NOT THE STORY

What happened is accurate and public. What it meant is unstable and private. The second is where the work is, and the site should show it working instead of explaining it.

HOW IT SHOULD SOUND

Short declaratives. Specific numbers. An occasional flat undercutting of its own serious sentence — “it takes about forty seconds and an email address.” Warmth is present but never performed, and the writing declines to be solemn without going for a laugh.

The second person is used sparingly and almost only for practical instruction. Situations are written unowned, so a reader can recognise themselves without being addressed and told what they feel.

EMBRACE

- Plain description of situations
- Numbers stated openly
- Named limits and refusals
- Unfinished sentences the reader completes
- Verbs rather than identity nouns

AVOID

- Journey, safe space, holding space
- “You deserve”, “it takes courage”
- Promises of happiness
- Condition lists and client categories
- Sustained second-person address

From eleven at night to four sentences.

FEEL

A small, unwelcome jolt of recognition, then relief that nothing is being sold. Met rather than soothed. The page should read as though an adult wrote it and is not performing.

UNDERSTAND

Within seconds: that you are a therapist, who you work with, where, when, what it costs, and that the first conversation is free and is not an assessment.

TRUST

Method described rather than asserted. Limits named. Price published. Awkward practical facts volunteered before they can be discovered.

DO

Arrange the twenty minutes — by telephone as readily as by video, with no requirement to explain the problem first.

THE ARC

ARRIVAL

Facts and fee first, so that scepticism is answered before feeling is asked for.

RECOGNITION

A sequence of unowned situations. Something close but not quite right, which the page should name as a good sign.

UNDERSTANDING

How you work, and then what an hour with you is actually for.

CONTACT

A short form whose optional field says that “I’m not sure how to describe this” is a complete answer.

STATED IN YOUR OWN VOICE, AS CONTENT RATHER THAN SMALL PRINT

First floor, no lift · Late-cancellation charge · Replies may take until the next working day · What this practice cannot serve, with plain crisis signposting

Nothing here should look like it is trying.

The identity should be quiet, exact and a little austere — closer to a well-made printed catalogue than to a clinic. It should look considered instead of current: nothing in it dates on a two-year cycle, and nothing is chosen because it is what therapy websites presently look like.

Its job is to make a sceptical reader relax by giving them nothing to be sceptical about. Precision is the reassurance.

Your practice runs on two registers — what a person says out loud, and what it turns out to have meant. Keeping those two apart, in type and in colour, is the single idea the identity is built on.

Slightly boring rather than fashionable.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

WHAT IT CARRIES

- Two registers, kept visibly apart
- Space used as a claim about manner
- Exactness in every number and measure
- One idea, held all the way through
- Warmth carried by the writing, not the styling

WHAT IT AVOIDS

- Sage, blush and gradient palettes
- Rounded cards, soft shadows, icon sets
- Script and handwritten type
- Stock photography of calm
- Anything that reads as a lifestyle brand

One thing, two readings.

Two brackets, offset so the frame never closes: one thing seen twice, slightly out of register. It is the idea your practice works with, drawn once.

The mark comes out of the wordmark instead of sitting beside it. Its arms are the cap height of *Sofia Marin* and its stroke matches the weight of the letters, so at any size the name and the mark read as one object.

CONSTRUCTION

- Arm length = cap height of the wordmark
- Offset = one word-space, on both axes
- Clear space = one cap height on all four sides
- Minimum width 96px; below that, the small-use variant
- Never outlined, rotated, boxed, or set on a photograph

PRIMARY LOCKUP



Cover, correspondence, print. The name sits inside a frame that is never completed.

MARK ALONE · SMALL USE



Favicon, and the marker placed beside any sentence the site asks you to read a second time. Small use thickens the stroke and halves the offset.

HORIZONTAL LOCKUP



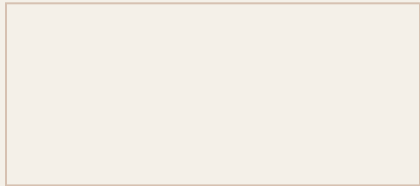
Website header and footer. Descriptor set in the grotesque, never in the serif.

ON AUBERGINE · SINGLE COLOUR



Plum lifts on dark grounds. Where one colour only is possible, both brackets take it and the offset does the work.

Five colours, each with one job.

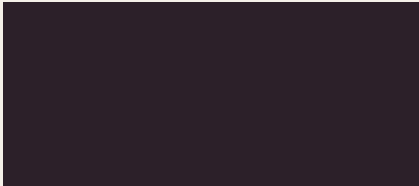


Parchment

#F4F0E8

THE PAGE

A warm, slightly aged white. The default ground for everything that is read, and most of what a visitor sees.



Aubergine

#2C2029

STATEMENT AND GROUND

All primary type on parchment, and the full-bleed ground on the pages where the practice states something instead of explaining it. A dark that is neither black nor navy.



Ash

#7C7076

LABEL

Anything that names something instead of saying it: section labels, captions, table headings, form hints, practical notes.



Plum

#6A2F4A

MEANING

Marks the meaning layer and nothing else: the section rule, the quotation bar, the second bracket of the mark, and the word whose meaning is in question. Never a button, never a fill. On aubergine it lifts to hold the same weight.



Clay

#A97C5F

HAIRLINE

Exists at one weight only, as the rules that separate information. Never a fill, never type, never a border around a box.

PROPORTION ON ANY SCREEN



Parchment 76 Aubergine 17 Ash 4 Clay 1.6 Plum 1.4

No sage, no blush, no gradient, no second accent. Each of these has a job and appears only where that job applies, which is what stops a palette becoming decoration.

A serif for meaning.
A grotesque for facts.

SPECTRAL · PRODUCTION TYPE

Aa Sofia Marin

Every meaning, every sentence of thinking, and every word you are quoted saying. Sharp, dry and slightly narrow — made for reading, not for display.

HIERARCHY

DISPLAY	Spectral Light, 46	The account is stable.
BODY	Spectral Regular, 13.5	A life is rarely mistaken about its facts.
QUOTED SPEECH	Spectral Light Italic, 21	<i>You don't have to arrive with it.</i>
LABEL	Archivo Medium, 9, letterspaced	HOW I WORK
LEDGER AND DATA	Archivo Regular, 12.5, tabular	£70 · 50 minutes · Tuesday to Friday

ARCHIVO · OMNIBUS-TYPE

£70 50 min Tue–Fri

FEE · AVAILABILITY · HOW I WORK · CONTACT

A grotesque built for small sizes and tables. It carries fees, times, labels, navigation, forms and practical notes, and nothing else. Regular 400 and Medium 500 only; tabular figures throughout.

THE RULE

A meaning never appears in the grotesque; a fee never appears in the serif. Your two registers become the two typefaces, and keeping them apart lets the difference show on the page without anyone explaining it.

NOT USED

- A third typeface, anywhere
- Italic for emphasis — emphasis is made by position
- Letterspaced or all-capital serif
- More than two sizes of heading on a page

A real person, plainly photographed.

THE PORTRAIT

One direct portrait in daylight, at eye level and from a normal conversational distance. Available light, no styling. Looking at the camera suits a practice this direct, though the shoot should find the version you can live with. It appears once, at a moderate size, and never behind text.

THE ROOM AND THE CITY

The rest is fragments — a chair, a window, a worn wall, a stretch of Brighton street. Documentary rather than arranged. They carry atmosphere; they do not illustrate the copy or explain you.

LIGHT AND TREATMENT

Daylight from one direction, with visible shadow. Nothing lit to look warm. Slightly desaturated, no filter and no grade towards cream or sage. Square corners, full bleed or full column, no vignette.

PLACEMENT

Photographs sit between sections rather than beside sentences, so that no image is asked to prove a claim. Anything overlaid on an image is attributed plainly and appears once.

SHOT LIST

01	02	03	04	05
The portrait, daylight, eye level	The street door — which entrance to look for	The room as a first visitor sees it from the door	One detail — the window, the wall, the light on the floor	One fragment of the city outside

A working list rather than a requirement. Five is the upper limit; four good photographs are better than five, and the site should work if the last one is never taken.

NOT PHOTOGRAPHED

Hands holding mugs · empty chairs · tissue boxes and candles · pebbles, beaches, forests · you mid-gesture or mid-laugh · anything staged to resemble a session · stock images of calm

What follows for the website.

Each requirement follows from a conclusion on an earlier page. If a conclusion changes when you review it, the requirement beside it changes with it.

STRATEGIC CONCLUSION	DESIGN REQUIREMENT
Recognition has to happen without a category being applied, because being read a certain way is part of what these clients are tired of.	No condition list, no “who I work with” panel, no client types. In their place, a sequence of situations written without an owner — spanning work, family, friendship, love, language and place — wide enough that no single group can claim the page as being about them.
The distinction between what happened and what it meant is what the practice actually works on.	It becomes the site's one interactive element instead of a paragraph. Two planes: a sentence fixed on the left, the meaning arriving and replacing itself on the right. The reader learns what a session is for by operating it.
This reader can see technique working on them, and reads warm second-person copy as being handled.	Almost no second person in the body copy. One direct address only — <i>you don't need to be able to say what it is</i> — placed beside the action and used once.
Sceptical, articulate people check what something costs before they read anything emotional.	Fee, session length, days and delivery mode in the first screen as a four-item ledger in plain numerals. The free twenty minutes named as an action, not a page.
Volunteering the awkward fact is how this practice earns trust.	The practical section written as content, not small print: the first floor and the absent lift, the charge for late cancellation, the reply that may not come until the next working day, and plain signposting for what the practice cannot serve.
Generous space is itself a claim about manner — that nothing here is being rushed or sold.	Wide margins and a short measure. Dense practical sections alternate with quiet ones, so the page can be skimmed in twenty seconds and still rewards a slow read.

The whole direction, on one page.

PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY

An integrative therapist who would rather be exact than comforting, and treats accuracy as the more useful kindness.

PHILOSOPHY

The account is stable; the meaning is not. Change comes from re-reading what happened rather than from correcting it.

VOICE

Dry, exact, unhurried. Warm without performing warmth. Declines to be solemn; never reaches for a laugh.

IDENTITY IDEA

One thing, two readings — two offset brackets that never close a frame.

VISUAL DIRECTION

Parchment and aubergine, plum for meaning only, one clay hairline. Spectral for thinking, Archivo for facts. Up to five photographs, wide margins, no ornament.

PEOPLE TO REACH

Adults whose lives are working and no longer feel like theirs — competent, articulate, wary of being categorised or handled.

CORE MESSAGE

Therapy for adults, for the point at which a life stops fitting.

DESIRED FEELING

Recognised without being labelled. Taken seriously by someone who will keep up.

WEBSITE PRIORITY

Make the free twenty minutes easy to ask for without knowing what it is about.

THE ONE TEST

A reader who has never met you should finish the page able to say what you think, what you are careful not to claim, and what it costs.

Does this sound like your practice?

Once you approve it, this Blueprint is the agreed direction for the website. The build then works from these pages, so the time goes into making the site good instead of settling the same questions twice. Clarity now is what removes the guesswork later.

Read it once quickly and once slowly. Where something is factually wrong, correct it. Where something is right but badly put, say so — that is an equally useful correction. Where you disagree with a recommendation, say what you would want instead, or simply say it isn't you, and we will find the version that is.

Two consolidated rounds of revision are included at this stage. Sending your comments together produces a better document and a faster build.

WHAT TO REVIEW

- Factual accuracy, and the details still to confirm
- Whether the description sounds like you
- The message and the voice
- Who the site speaks to most directly
- The identity and the mark
- Colour and typography
- Photography, and what you are willing to be photographed doing
- The website requirements on page 14

AFTER APPROVAL

Design begins from the direction agreed here, so the website can focus on bringing it to life instead of reopening the same decisions.



Prepared by Alexander Watson Studio · alexanderwatson.co.uk